



Reference Section

Ten operational quick-reference tools: fee charts, rate schedules, sizing formulas, sector guides, proposal checklists, standard letter templates, and the complete leadership roster.

M.1 Document Types Quick Guide	M.2 Five-Phase Structure	M.3 Proposal Narrative Rules
M.4 Standard Letter Templates	M.5 Master Fee Chart	M.6 Rate Schedule 2026
M.7 Sizing Formulas	M.8 Sector Quick Reference	M.9 Pre-Flight Checklist
M.10 Leadership & Offices		

M.1 · PROPOSAL REFERENCE

Document Types Quick Guide

Four solicitation document types, their focus, what the client wants, and what *Create The Edge* submits in response. Always read the actual document before classifying.

DOCUMENT	FOCUS	CLIENT WANTS	CREATE THE EDGE SUBMITS
RFQ Request for Qualifications	Competency	Proof of relevant experience for this specific scope, sector, and scale	Resumes, headshots, photos of completed projects, SF 330 Part I & II
RFP Request for Proposal	Objective/Approach	A decision tool: exactly how will you meet our goals and at what cost?	Fee calculation + Letter of Objective + full scope of work (four instruments)
IDIQ Indefinite Delivery, Indefinite Quantity	Flexibility/Readiness	Pre-qualified firm available on short notice for task orders over a contract term	Full qualifications package; pricing schedule for task-order work
On-Call Services	Readiness	Pre-established contract; firm starts work immediately as projects arise	Qualifications package; executed master agreement with pre- negotiated rates

WATCH OUT

Some clients do not clearly distinguish between RFQ and RFP. Some issue hybrid documents. Submitting a fee in response to a pure RFQ disqualifies you at many institutions. Submitting only qualifications in response to a full RFP costs you the job. Read the actual document before deciding which format applies. When in doubt, ask [Department Manager].

SF 330 Completion Workflow

FOR GOVERNMENT RFQ RESPONSES

Step 1 — Identify five past projects using the bullseye method	Same architect + sector + location first
Step 2 — Project description	Copy paragraphs 1–2 from original proposal verbatim
Step 3 — Estimated equipment cost	Pull from AutoQuotes project record
Step 4 — Part II (firm stats)	Update date; signature already in place
[Department Manager]'s rule	"It is a reading test. If we can read, we pass."

M.2 · PROPOSAL REFERENCE

Five-Phase Structure Reference

The standard *Create The Edge* five-phase structure, phase percentages, meeting counts, deliverables, and variant formats for non-standard project types.

PHASE	NAME	% OF FEE	STANDARD MEETINGS	KEY DELIVERABLES	PRIMARY RISK PREVENTED
I	Schematic Design (SD)	20%	1 in-person + 4 Teams/Zoom	Space program review, schematic plans, preliminary equipment list, preliminary cost estimate	Congestion and oversizing

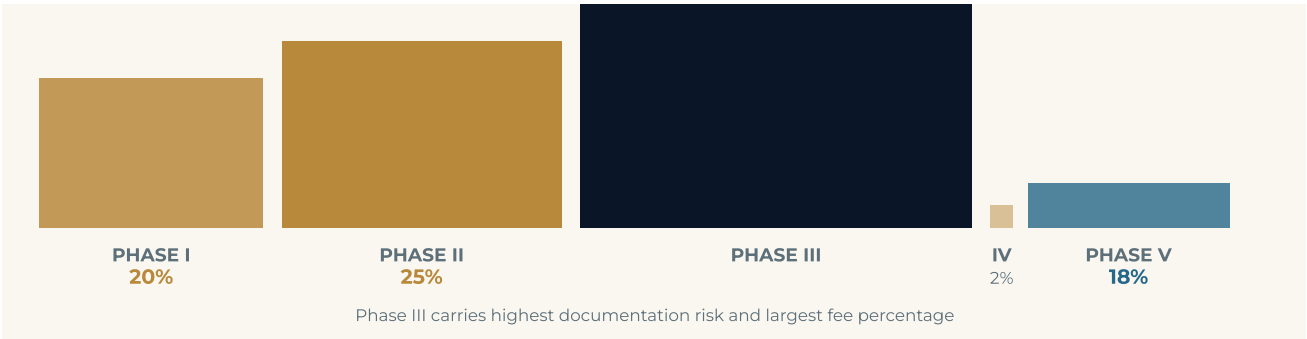
PHASE	NAME	% OF FEE	STANDARD MEETINGS	KEY DELIVERABLES	PRIMARY RISK PREVENTED
II	Design Development (DD)	25%	6 Teams/Zoom	Equipment plans in Revit at 1/4" scale, data books, connection plans, updated cost estimate	MEP conflicts
III	Construction Documents (CD)	35%	1 in-person + 8 Teams/Zoom	Final plans, elevations, specifications for bid, regulatory reviews	Contractor disputes (highest doc risk)
IV	Bidding/Negotiations (BN)	2%	No meetings unless requested	Addenda, bid review and alternates, contractor evaluation	Owner overpayment
V	Construction Administration (CA)	18%	1 site visit (floor penetrations) + 1 site visit with written report	Submittal review, RFI responses, punch list	Installation deviation
TOTAL		100%	Additional meetings billed at \$225/hr. Site visits beyond 50 miles: \$1,600/day + \$0.665/mile		

Phase Variant Formats

FORMAT	PHASES	WHEN TO USE
3-Phase	SD/DD combined, CD, CA	Smaller projects, fire stations, simple renovations
4-Phase	Programming + SD, DD, CD, CA	Renovations requiring pre-design assessment of existing conditions

FORMAT	PHASES	WHEN TO USE
5-Phase (Standard)	SD, DD, CD, BN, CA	Default for new construction; most common format
6-Phase	Programming + SD, DD, CD, BN, CA	Complex renovations; multi-site; staged delivery
7-Phase	Adds Closeout or Equipment Survey	Large institutional contracts; government multi-phase programs

FIGURE M.2.1 • PHASE FEE DISTRIBUTION



🔑 RULE OF THE HOUSE

Delivery markers (30/60/90/100%) within each phase apply on complex multi-site or phased delivery jobs. Each marker triggers a review meeting and a potential progress invoice. Meetings beyond the standard count are billed at \$225/hour without exception. State the meeting count explicitly in every proposal to prevent disputes.

M.3 • PROPOSAL REFERENCE

Proposal Narrative Rules

The structural and stylistic rules governing every client-facing sentence *Create The Edge* writes. These are not guidelines; they are the standard against which every proposal is validated before it leaves the office.

Two-Paragraph Rule

Paragraph 1 — Context (Why)

IDENTIFY THE PROJECT'S IMPORTANCE AND THE CLIENT'S SITUATION

Impact	What does completing this project accomplish?
Critical Event	What happens if the timeline or budget is missed?
Emotional Decision	How will the end-user feel when it is done?
Rational Decision	Square footage, population, budget, menu preferences

Paragraph 2 — Scope (What)

DESCRIBE CREATE THE EDGE'S EXACT DESIGN SCOPE

Spaces designed	List every space with exact SF (round to whole numbers)
Equipment approach	Key equipment features and Create The Edge's design strategy
Client benefit	How Create The Edge's approach specifically benefits this client

✓ WRITE THIS

"This renovation will modernize kitchen and laundry infrastructure to support projected occupancy increases while minimizing long-term capital, labor, and utility costs."

"The 1,167 SF kitchen serving 490 residents will require a design that balances security, operational efficiency, and long-term durability."

State abbreviations: GA, NC, FL, AL

Round numbers: 438 SF, not 437.86 SF

X NEVER WRITE THIS

"We are pleased to present this proposal."

"We hope to meet your expectations."

"We look forward to the opportunity."

"Emotionally, the client wants..."

"Rationally, the decision is driven by..."

Em dashes anywhere in any document

Full state names: [State], [State]

SECTOR	INDEPENDENCE LANGUAGE
Standard / Hospitality	"F&B independence" — emphasis on balanced experience, efficiency, and cost control
Correctional	Emphasizes security, operational efficiency, and long-term durability
Education (K-12)	"Foodservice independence" — student nutrition, service efficiency, operating cost management
Healthcare / Senior Living	Patient/resident care, nutrition, safety, cost
Religious	Fellowship, community, ministry outreach, stewardship

{ EXPERT INSIGHT

*"They don't buy **Create The Edge** or foodservice equipment. They buy results to their problem. We took out **Create The Edge**, we took out the I."*

· Marketing Director

M.4 · LEGAL REFERENCE

Standard Letter Templates

*Four standard legal documents used in every **Create The Edge** client engagement. Templates live in the standard templates folder; update the project name and date before every use. Never send without review.*

01

STANDARD DOCUMENT

Consultation Agreement

Binding contract included as final pages of every fee proposal. Key terms: 7-day termination notice; net-30 payment; reactivation fee after 4-month suspension; no work before signature. Supersedes all prior negotiations. Article II sets the maximum fee and phase breakdown.

02

STANDARD DOCUMENT

Variance Letter

Issued when client requires insurance coverage beyond **Create The Edge's** policy. Describes limited scope (drawings only; no products, no installation; 2–3 site visits per project). Cites 57+ year zero-claims record. Signed: Cathey Create The Edge, CEO. Attached to proposal; does not modify Consultation Agreement.

03

STANDARD DOCUMENT

Litigation Letter

Certification of legal status required by government/institutional clients. Standard language: "**Create The Edge** is not or has not been involved in any active or pending litigation... nor have any current or former associates (within past five years)." Signed: [Company Owner] C. Create The Edge, FCSI, CSI, President.

04

STANDARD DOCUMENT

Proposal Email Template

Standard email language for transmitting a completed proposal. Includes fee amount, invitation to review and contact with questions, instruction to sign and return or send AIA agreement. Signed with Associate's name. Always verify the recipient email before sending.

Insurance Coverage (2026)

COVERAGE TYPE	PER OCCURRENCE	AGGREGATE
Worker's Compensation	\$1,000,000	\$1,000,000
General Liability	\$2,000,000	\$4,000,000
Automobile Liability	\$1,000,000	\$1,000,000
Excess (Umbrella) Liability	\$6,000,000	\$6,000,000
Cyber Liability	\$1,000,000	\$1,000,000
Professional Liability	\$2,000,000/claim	\$5,000,000

✓ BEST PRACTICE

In 57+ years of operation across thousands of projects, **Create The Edge** has never had a claim on any insurance coverage. This record is cited explicitly in the variance letter. It is one of the firm's most powerful credibility signals and must be stated accurately and prominently whenever insurance is discussed.

SECTION M · REFERENCE · M.5

M.5 · FEE REFERENCE

Master Fee Chart 2026

The complete per-square-foot equipment cost schedule and fee percentage ranges by sector and space type. All figures from the 2026 Fee Calculations spreadsheet. Verify with [Department Manager] before using on any government or correctional project where sector premiums may apply.

Sector Rates

SECTOR	EST. COST/SF	FEE %	NOTES
Schools (K-12)	\$300– \$325/SF	4–6%	Includes Programming through CA
Higher Education	\$300/SF	5%	8 SF/student × 40% participation ÷ 2.75 turns
Hospitality (Kitchen)	\$325/SF	3.5– 5%	F&B storage + zero-step bartending
Healthcare / Senior Living	\$300/SF	4–5%	5% unless [Company Owner] specifies otherwise
Correctional (≤10,000 SF)	\$300/SF	4– 4.5%	CA % increased for security coordination
Correctional (>10,000 SF)	\$225– \$250/SF	4– 4.5%	[Department Manager]'s simplified: 4.5% of equipment budget

SECTOR	EST. COST/SF	FEE %	NOTES
Catering / Warming Kitchen	\$200– \$250/SF	5%	Context-dependent; consider adjacency to dry storage
Teaching / Training Kitchen	\$250– \$300/SF	5%	
Stadium / Arena Concessions	\$250– \$300/SF	5%	
Corporate Cafeteria	\$300/SF	5%	20 SF/employee × 40% participation ÷ 2.5 turns
Military / Federal	Industry SF	5–8%	Multi-station, compliance rigor, 24/7 readiness
Religious	\$250/SF	4.75%	

Space-Type Cost Reference

SPACE TYPE	UNIT COST	NOTES
Dry Storage / Pantry	\$100/SF	
Walk-in Cooler / Freezer	\$300/SF	
Servery	\$250/SF	Verify current pricing
Dishwash Area	\$600/SF	Verify current pricing
Exhaust Hood	\$3,000/linear ft	K–12 Schools
Serving Line	\$2,500/linear ft	K–12 Schools
Sneeze Guard	\$350/linear ft	

Bar & Beverage Estimates

TYPE	EST. COST	SF RANGE
Pool Bar	\$25,000	

TYPE	EST. COST	SF RANGE
Small Bar (<12 seats)	\$50,000–\$60,000	150–200 SF
Medium Bar (12–24 seats)	\$60,000–\$70,000	200–300 SF
Large Bar (>24 seats)	\$70,000–\$80,000	300–450+ SF
Coffee Bar / Café	\$80,000–\$120,000	Espresso machines alone: \$40,000+
Senior Living Bar	\$45,000 minimum	
Market / Grab-and-Go	\$15,000–\$30,000	Airscreen, reach-in fridge/freezer
School Concessions	\$55,000	Popcorn, hotdog roller, pizza warmer

Fee Calculation Methods

Method A — Square Foot × Sector Rate

MOST COMMON METHOD FOR KITCHEN PROJECTS

Step 1: Calculate equipment cost	Kitchen SF × Sector \$/SF = Equipment Cost
Step 2: Add specialty areas	Walk-in SF × \$300 + Hood LF × \$3,000 etc.
Step 3: Apply fee %	Total Equipment Cost × Sector Fee % = Proposed Fee
Example (K-12)	1,167 SF × \$300 = \$350,100 + \$49,200 cooler = \$399,300 × 4% = \$15,972

Method B — Equipment Budget Percentage

USED WHEN CLIENT PROVIDES AN EQUIPMENT BUDGET DIRECTLY

Formula	Fee ÷ Equipment Budget = Fee %
Example	\$17,400 ÷ \$270,000 = 6.4%

Method C — Laundry (15-Lb Rule)

FOR HOTEL AND INSTITUTIONAL LAUNDRY PROJECTS

Standard hotel	$\text{Keys} \times 15 \text{ lbs/day} \div 7 \text{ hrs} = \text{lbs/hour capacity}$
Luxury hotel	$\text{Keys} \times 20 \text{ lbs/day} \div 7 \text{ hrs} = \text{lbs/hour capacity}$
Correctional	$\text{Inmates} \times 3 \text{ lbs/day} \div 7 \text{ hrs} = \text{lbs/hour capacity}$
Example (200-key standard)	$200 \times 15 = 3,000 \text{ lbs} \div 7 = 428 \text{ lbs/hr} \rightarrow 2 \text{ washers} + 3 \text{ dryers (200-lb)}$

SECTION M · REFERENCE · M.6

M.6 · FEE REFERENCE

Rate Schedule 2026

Hourly and day rates for all billable positions, travel billing rules, and payment terms. All additional services not covered in the base contract are billed at these rates.

Hourly & Day Rates

POSITION	HOURLY RATE	DAY RATE
Project Principal	\$275/hr	\$1,900/day
Senior Project Manager	\$250/hr	\$1,700/day
Project Manager	\$225/hr	\$1,600/day
Quality Control Coordinator	\$200/hr	—
Project Coordinator	\$150/hr	—
Revit Operator / BIM Manager	\$160/hr	—
Specifications Writer	\$120/hr	—

POSITION	HOURLY RATE	DAY RATE
Administrative Coordinator	\$100/hr	—
Additional PM Meetings (all levels)	\$225/hr	—

Travel Billing (50-Mile Rule)

Travel Beyond 50 Miles from [City, State] Office		
ALWAYS BILLED AS SEPARATE LINE ITEMS; NEVER BUNDLED INTO BASE FEE		
Site visit day rate		\$1,600/day (PM rate)
Mileage reimbursement		\$0.665/mile (IRS standard rate 2026)
Mileage formula	(Office → Site + Site → Office) × Number of Meetings = Total Miles × \$0.665	
Additional meetings	\$225/hr beyond contract count (all personnel levels)	

Payment Terms

TERM	DETAIL
Payment due	Net 30 days from receipt of invoice
Invoice date	1st of each month or agreed-upon dates
Phase invoicing	Invoiced at start of each phase per the phase percentage breakdown
Additional services	Billed at hourly rates above; net 30
Suspension reactivation	Reactivation fee applies if project suspended 4+ consecutive months
Work initiation	No work begins before signature on Consultation Agreement or AIA agreement

🔑 RULE OF THE HOUSE

Travel costs are never bundled into the base fee. They are always stated as explicit separate line items in the proposal. A proposal that absorbs travel costs misrepresents **Create The Edge's** true cost of service and undermines the firm's ability to recover those costs on extended or multi-visit projects.

M.7 · DESIGN REFERENCE

Kitchen & Laundry Sizing Formulas

Population-driven and area-driven formulas for calculating kitchen square footage and laundry capacity requirements across all major sectors. These formulas are the starting point; final sizing always requires field verification and [Department Manager] review.

Kitchen Sizing by Facility Type

FACILITY TYPE	UNIT	SF FORMULA	NOTES
Hospice	Bed	25 SF/bed	
Senior Living	Person	10 SF/person	
Rehabilitation / Mental Health	Bed	20 SF/bed	No retail
Hospital	Bed	40 SF/bed	With retail component
Correctional (first 500 inmates)	Inmate	10 SF/inmate	
Correctional (501-1,000 inmates)	Inmate	9 SF/inmate	Economies of scale

FACILITY TYPE	UNIT	SF FORMULA	NOTES
Higher Education	Student	$8 \text{ SF} \times 40\% \text{ participation} \div 2.75 \text{ turns}$	
Corporate Cafeteria	Employee	$20 \text{ SF} \times 40\% \text{ participation} \div 2.5 \text{ turns}$	
Catering / Warming Kitchen	Space	15–20 SF/person or 10–20% of total facility SF	

Laundry Sizing Reference

Hotel Laundry Formula

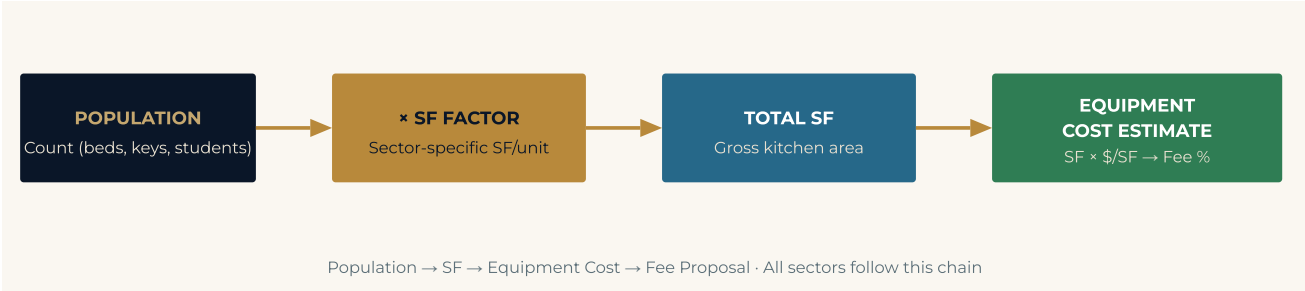
15-POUND RULE FOR STANDARD HOTEL OPERATIONS

Standard hotel	15 lbs of laundry per key per day
Luxury hotel (spa / multiple pools)	20 lbs per key per day
Prison / correctional	3 lbs per inmate per day
Working hours	$\div 7 \text{ working hours} = \text{lbs/hour capacity required}$

Equipment Sizing Example — 192-Key Standard Hotel

WORKED CALCULATION FROM THE CREATE THE EDGE TRAINING RECORD

Daily volume	$192 \text{ keys} \times 15 \text{ lbs} = 2,880 \text{ lbs/day}$
Hourly capacity	$2,880 \div 7 \text{ hrs} = 412 \text{ lbs/hour}$
Washers required	200-lb washer, 45-min cycle = 267 lbs/hr capacity → 2 washers
Dryers required	200-lb dryer, 60-min cycle = 200 lbs/hr capacity → 3 dryers
Standard equipment list	2 washer-extractors + 3 dryer tumblers + floor trough, lint collector, ozone machine, linen carts, folding tables, hand sink, laundry sink, shelving



M.8 · SECTOR REFERENCE

Sector Quick Reference

Nine sectors served by *Create The Edge*, each with its primary client drivers, terminology rules, competitive positioning, and sector-specific design constraints. Use this as a fast brief before a client call or proposal kickoff.

SECTOR	PRIMARY DRIVERS	KEY TERMINOLOGY / RULES	CREATE THE EDGE DIFFERENTIATOR
Education (K-12)	Student health, behavior, learning outcomes, 30-min service windows, allergen protection, federal fruit/veg compliance	Federal nutrition standards; USDA guidelines; exhaust hood LF pricing; serving line LF pricing	SE regional depth; federal nutrition compliance expertise
Higher Education	Volume, speed, multiple concepts, student experience, sustainability	8 SF/student formula; 40% participation; 2.75 turns; all-you-care-to-eat operations	Multi-concept design; AI food waste monitoring integration
Transportation (Airports)	Passenger throughput, brand standards, concession revenue, 24/7 ops	Terminal F&B; [Airport Lounge Design] ([Major Airport Portfolio]); airside constraints	Major Transportation Hospitality Project portfolio; [Multi-Site Airport Experience];

SECTOR	PRIMARY DRIVERS	KEY TERMINOLOGY / RULES	CREATE THE EDGE DIFFERENTIATOR
			[Team Member] legacy
Healthcare / Senior Living	Resident/patient care, nutrition, safety, infection control, JCAHO compliance	25 SF/bed (hospice); 10 SF/person (senior living); 40 SF/bed (hospital with retail); infection control zoning	Louise Howard (130+ projects since 1996); Banner UMC marketplace concept
Hospitality	Guest satisfaction, F&B revenue, zero-step bartending, ambiance, labor efficiency	F&B independence; 15-lb laundry rule; \$325/SF kitchen; pool bar/lobby bar/speakeasy pricing	Full F&B + laundry scope; Star Metals District portfolio
Government / Military	Multi-station, 24/7 readiness, compliance rigor, security, no-maintenance engineering	SF 330 required; Marine Corps no-maintenance rule; industrial dehydrators (West Point 7,492 lbs turkey); IDIQ contracting	Military-grade logistics; West Point/Marine Corps portfolio; DFW experience
Corrections	Security, efficiency, durability, volume, inmate density	Use "residents" or "persons," NEVER "inmates" in client-facing text; 10 SF/inmate; 3 lbs laundry/inmate/day; Blair County precedent (\$52K fee / 4,900 SF / 490 residents)	SE correctional portfolio; security-package equipment specification
Corporate / Catering	Efficiency, value, capital cost minimization, employee satisfaction	\$200–\$250/SF catering; 5%; 20 SF/employee formula	Multi-site corporate programs; grab-and-go market integration
Large Venues (Stadiums)	High-volume concessions, speed of service, revenue per transaction	\$250–\$300/SF concessions; concession stand layout; commissary kitchen coordination	Stadium + arena concession portfolio

Blair County Prison: 4,900 SF / 490 residents / \$52,000 approved fee. This is the correctional sector benchmark case. The language in the proposal used "residents" throughout at [Department Manager]'s direction. The CA percentage was increased beyond the standard 18% to account for heightened security coordination requirements during installation. Cite this case when explaining correctional sector pricing to any client or team member.

M.9 · OPERATIONAL REFERENCE

Pre-Flight Checklist

The mandatory quality check before any proposal leaves the office. Every box must be confirmed. A proposal sent without completing this checklist is a proposal sent at risk.

Content & Scope

□ Sector-specific independence paragraph	correct (F&B, Foodservice, Correctional, Education, Healthcare, or Religious variant as appropriate)
□ Square footage	stated for every designed area; rounded to whole numbers; matches the FTE/bed/key count and equipment budget
□ Two-paragraph intro only	(context + scope); no marketing fluff; no framework labels (emotional, rational, critically) in client text
□ Letter of Objective	included for all RFP responses (not required for RFQ)
□ Phase titles accurate	(SD/DD/CD/BN/CA or variant format appropriate for this project type)
□ Meeting counts confirmed	and stated explicitly; additional meetings billed at \$225/hr language included

□ **All spaces listed** in the cover letter and in the Whereas clause of the Consultation Agreement

□ **MasterSpec and MEP loads** reviewed for coordination accuracy

Format & Compliance

□ **Travel line items** separated from base fee; \$1,600/day + \$0.665/mile beyond 50 miles from [City, State]

□ **Insurance limits** stated (\$2M/\$5M Professional; \$2M/\$4M General Liability)

□ **"Create The Edge" lowercase, bold, #266889** throughout; never capitalized as a brand name

□ **No em dashes** anywhere in the document; use commas, semicolons, or full sentences instead

□ **US state abbreviations only** (GA, NC, FL, AL); never full state names in formal text

□ **No juvenile phrasing** ("we are pleased," "we hope," "we look forward," "thank you for the opportunity")

□ **Round numbers** in narrative (438 SF, not 437.86 SF)

□ **Date and contact info** current and correct; no stale dates from prior proposals

Risk Flags & Final Steps

□ **Flags raised** for any scope risks, undersized areas, or code conditions identified during document review

□ **Variance letter attached** if client requires coverage beyond current policy limits

□ **Litigation letter attached** if required by the RFQ/RFP solicitation documents

□ **SF 330 selected** using the bullseye method; five projects most relevant to this sector/architect/geography

□ **Filed in [CRM Software]** with two-paragraph narrative saved in the project record

□ **Filed Year-Month-XX** naming convention in Box

{ **EXPERT INSIGHT**

"The square footage in the proposal is your protection. If scope grows from 400 SF to 1,200 SF, the written proposal proves what was contracted and gives the firm the right to request additional service compensation."

· Marketing Director

SECTION M · REFERENCE · M.10

M.10 · PERSONNEL & OFFICES REFERENCE

Leadership & Office Locations

The *Create The Edge* leadership roster, credential reference, primary and satellite offices, and contact information. Use for SF 330 personnel sections, RFQ submissions, and client-facing qualification materials.

Leadership Roster

NAME	TITLE	CREDENTIALS	AREA OF AUTHORITY
[Company Owner] C. Create The Edge	President	FCSI, CSI, FE&S Consultant of the Year, Chair FCSI-Americas	Firm leadership, final proposal authority, public representation
Cathey Create The Edge	CEO	SDA, CSI	Operations, legal authority (signs variance letters), firm administration
Brett Daniel	VP, BIM/Revit Manager	FCSI	BIM coordination, clash detection, Revit production management

NAME	TITLE	CREDENTIALS	AREA OF AUTHORITY
Howard Stanford	Operations Director	FCSI	Project operations, production oversight
Marketing Director	VP Business Development	FCSI, LEED GA, WELL AP	Sales strategy, proposal standards, all [Department Manager]-standard callout attributions
Louise Howard	Senior Living / Healthcare Specialist		Healthcare and senior living design; 130+ projects since 1996

Primary Offices

LOCATION	STATUS	ADDRESS / NOTES
[City, State]	Headquarters	[Company Address] · (770) 582-1144 · (800) 849-0520 · www.[Company Website]
Charlotte, NC	Primary Hub	
Birmingham, AL	Primary Hub	

Satellite Offices

ACTIVE SATELLITE LOCATIONS		
SunRiver, OR	Westfield, IN	Savannah, TN
Rock Hill, SC	York, SC	Climax, GA
Eufaula, AL	Elba, AL	Lutz, FL

Competitive Positioning Reference

COMPETITOR	KNOWN FOR	CREATE THE EDGE WINS ON
Ricca Design Studios	14,000+ projects; LEED leadership	SE regional depth; federal readiness

COMPETITOR	KNOWN FOR	CREATE THE EDGE WINS ON
Cini-Little International	Whole-building waste; urban infill	HMBE certification; SE/Latin America
Clevenger Associates	Carbon-neutral corporate; technical rigor	Military; stadium
Rippe Associates	16-year avg client tenure	International; military robotics
FCS	SWAM/WBE certifications	International; military
SSA Foodservice	NFL stadiums; Engineering Theater	Military; healthcare

🔑 RULE OF THE HOUSE

Only Marketing Director receives named attributions in callout boxes in training documents and proposals. All other leadership members speak in the body voice of the document without attribution. In SF 330 forms, all personnel receive their full name and credentials. In client proposals, the firm's credentials are cited collectively unless a specific team member's involvement is contractually relevant.

SECTION M · ASSESSMENT · 15-QUESTION QUIZ

M · KNOWLEDGE ASSESSMENT

Reference Section Assessment

Fifteen questions covering fee calculation, rate schedule, sizing formulas, sector rates, proposal rules, legal templates, and the Pre-Flight Checklist. The answers live in the reference pages of this module.

1

A 200-key hotel uses the 15-lb/day standard. What is the required laundry capacity in lbs/hour?

- ☐ A 200 lbs/hr
- ☐ B 300 lbs/hr
- ☐ C 428 lbs/hr
- ☐ D 500 lbs/hr

2

What is the 2026 hourly rate for a Revit Operator / BIM Manager?

- ☐ A \$120/hr
- ☐ B \$150/hr
- ☐ C \$160/hr
- ☐ D \$200/hr

3

Which phase of the five-phase structure carries 35% of the fee and the highest documentation risk?

- ☐ A Phase I — Programming (20%)
- ☐ B Phase II — Design Development (25%)
- ☐ C Phase III — Construction Documents (35%)
- ☐ D Phase V — Construction Administration (18%)

4

What is the estimated equipment cost per square foot for a K-12 school project?

- ☐ A \$200/SF
- ☐ B \$250/SF
- ☐ C \$300/SF
- ☐ D \$350/SF

5

Who signs the Variance Letter when a client requests insurance coverage beyond Create The Edge's current policy?

- ☐ A [Company Owner] C. Create The Edge, President
- ☐ B Marketing Director
- ☐ C Cathey Create The Edge, CEO
- ☐ D Brett Daniel, VP BIM/Revit Manager

6

Which of the following is the correct vendor-neutral language for a hospitality sector proposal?

- ☐ A Foodservice independence
- ☐ B F&B independence
- ☐ C Operational independence
- ☐ D Equipment neutrality

7

A hospital with 300 beds uses the standard healthcare formula. What is the estimated kitchen square footage?

- ☐ A 3,000 SF
- ☐ B 6,000 SF
- ☐ C 9,000 SF
- ☐ D 12,000 SF

8

What is the 2026 day rate for a site visit that requires travel beyond 50 miles from [City, State]?

- ☐ A \$1,275/day
- ☐ B \$1,500/day
- ☐ C \$1,600/day
- ☐ D \$225/hr only; no day rate applies

9

The Pre-Flight Checklist is organized into three groups. Which group specifically addresses scope ambiguities that could escalate to disputes?

- ☐ A Content and Scope
- ☐ B Format and Compliance
- ☐ C Risk Flags and Final Steps
- ☐ D Proposal Narrative Rules

10

Fee Calculation Method B is most reliable for which project condition?

- ☐ A New construction where population is precisely known
- ☐ B Projects where the client provides a stated equipment budget
- ☐ C Renovation projects where facility area is established in a programming document
- ☐ D Military projects governed by UFC design standards

11

What is Create The Edge's documented record on insurance claims across 57+ years of operation?

- ☐ A Three minor claims, all resolved without litigation
- ☐ B Zero claims on any coverage
- ☐ C One claim on Professional Liability, settled in 2004
- ☐ D Claims history is confidential and not referenced in proposals

12

Which sector uses the phrase "residents" rather than "inmates" in all client-facing proposal language?

- ☐ A Military Sector
- ☐ B Healthcare Sector
- ☐ C Correctional Sector
- ☐ D Government Sector

13

Which of the following is NOT a required element of the Format and Compliance group on the Pre-Flight Checklist?

- ☐ A "Create The Edge" lowercase, bold, #266889 throughout
- ☐ B Travel line items separated from base fee
- ☐ C SWOT analysis completed for this pursuit
- ☐ D No em dashes anywhere in the document

14

What does the SF 330 Bullseye selection method prioritize when choosing the five past projects to submit?

- ☐ A Highest fee dollar value
- ☐ B Most recently completed projects
- ☐ C Same architect + same sector + same location as the solicitation
- ☐ D Largest square footage per project

15

At Create The Edge, which position holds the authority to sign letters that certify the firm has not been involved in any active or pending litigation?

- ☐ A Cathey Create The Edge, CEO
- ☐ B Marketing Director
- ☐ C [Company Owner] C. Create The Edge, President
- ☐ D Brett Daniel, VP BIM/Revit Manager

QUESTION 1**C — 428 lbs/hr**

200 keys × 15 lbs = 3,000 lbs/day ÷ 7 working hours = 428.6 lbs/hr. The formula applies to standard hotel operations. Luxury hotels use 20 lbs/key. Ref: M.7 Sizing Formulas.

QUESTION 2**C — \$160/hr**

The 2026 Revit Operator / BIM Manager rate is \$160/hr. No day rate applies for this position. Ref: M.6 Rate Schedule 2026.

QUESTION 3**C — Phase III — Construction Documents (35%)**

CD carries the largest fee share and highest documentation risk. Errors discovered here drive contractor disputes and change orders. Ref: M.2 Five-Phase Structure Reference.

QUESTION 4**C — \$300/SF**

K-12 school projects: \$300/SF estimated equipment cost, 4-6% fee range. Verify current rate with [Department Manager] before applying to a government submission. Ref: M.5 Master Fee Chart.

QUESTION 5**C — Cathey Create The Edge, CEO**

The Variance Letter is signed by the CEO. The Litigation Letter is signed by the President. Knowing which officer signs which document is a precision requirement, not a detail. Ref: M.4 Standard Letter Templates.

QUESTION 6**B — F&B independence**

Hospitality proposals use "F&B independence." Education and healthcare use "Foodservice independence." The language must match the sector. Ref: M.3 Proposal Narrative Rules.

QUESTION 7**D — 12,000 SF**

Hospital formula with retail component: 40 SF/bed. 300 beds × 40 SF = 12,000 SF. Hospice uses 25 SF/bed; rehabilitation/mental health uses 20 SF/bed (no retail). Ref: M.7 Sizing Formulas.

QUESTION 8

C — \$1,600/day

The PM site visit day rate beyond 50 miles from [City, State] is \$1,600/day. Mileage at \$0.665/mile is additional. Both are separate line items; never bundled into the base fee. Ref: M.6 Rate Schedule 2026.

Answer Key · Questions 9 through 15

QUESTION 9

C — Risk Flags and Final Steps

Group 3 (Risk Flags) specifically addresses scope ambiguities, missing authorizations, and unaddressed client requirements that could generate disputes. Group 1 is content; Group 2 is formatting. Ref: M.9 Pre-Flight Checklist.

QUESTION 10

C — Renovation projects where facility area is established

Method B is the square-foot-based approach: most reliable when area is known from a programming document or preliminary plan. Method A is population-driven (new construction). Method C is budget-backed. Ref: M.5 Master Fee Chart.

QUESTION 11

B — Zero claims on any coverage

In 57+ years of operation across thousands of projects, Create The Edge has never had a claim on any insurance policy. This record is cited explicitly in the Variance Letter. It is one of the firm's most powerful credibility signals. Ref: M.4 Standard Letter Templates.

QUESTION 12

C — Correctional Sector

[Department Manager]'s instruction: always use "residents" or "persons" in correctional sector client-facing text, never "inmates." This applies to all proposals, emails, and presentations. Ref: M.8 Sector Quick Reference.

QUESTION 13

C — SWOT analysis completed for this pursuit

The SWOT analysis is a pre-proposal pursuit qualification tool; it is not a Pre-Flight Checklist item. The checklist validates document quality before release, not pursuit strategy before proposal. Ref: M.9 Pre-Flight Checklist.

QUESTION 14

C — Same architect + same sector + same location

The Bullseye targets relevance, not value or recency. The center bullseye is: same architect who issued the RFQ, same sector as the solicitation, same geographic area. Expand outward only when no bullseye match exists. Ref: M.1 Document Types Quick Guide.

QUESTION 15

C — [Company Owner] C. Create The Edge, President

The Litigation Letter certifying no active or pending litigation is signed by the President, [Company Owner] C. Create The Edge. The Variance Letter (insurance exception) is signed by the CEO, Cathey Create The Edge. These are distinct documents with distinct signatories. Ref: M.4 Standard Letter Templates.

STUDY TOOLS

Flashcard Reference Grid

Twelve precision reference cards for the most frequently tested values and rules in the Reference Section.

#	TERM / RULE	REFERENCE	KEY VALUE OR FACT
1	Phase III Fee %	M.2	35% of total fee; Construction Documents; highest documentation risk of all five phases.
2	Laundry Formula	M.7	Keys × 15 lbs ÷ 7 hrs = lbs/hr. Luxury = 20 lbs. Correctional = 3 lbs/inmate.
3	K-12 Rate	M.5	\$300/SF estimated equipment cost; 4-6% fee range.

#	TERM / RULE	REFERENCE	KEY VALUE OR FACT
4	Hospitality Rate	M.5	\$325/SF kitchen; 3.5-5% fee range. F&B independence language.
5	Hospital SF Formula	M.7	40 SF/bed (with retail). Hospice: 25 SF/bed. Rehab: 20 SF/bed (no retail).
6	Variance Letter Signer	M.4	Cathey Create The Edge, CEO. (Litigation Letter: [Company Owner] C. Create The Edge, President.)
7	Travel Billing	M.6	\$1,600/day + \$0.665/mile beyond 50 miles from [City, State]. Always a separate line item.
8	Revit Rate	M.6	\$160/hr. Production drawings, BIM coordination, clash detection support.
9	Principal Rate	M.6	\$275/hr and \$1,500/day. Highest billable position in the rate schedule.
10	Correctional Language	M.8	Use "residents" or "persons" in all client-facing text. Never "inmates."
11	Insurance Record	M.4	Zero claims on any coverage in 57+ years of operation. Cited in the Variance Letter.
12	Pre-Flight Group 3	M.9	Risk Flags and Final Steps: scope ambiguities, missing authorizations, unaddressed client requirements.

SECTION M · ASSESSMENT · INTERACTIVE FLASHCARDS

STUDY TOOLS · SCREEN ONLY

Interactive Flip Cards

Click or tap any card to reveal the answer. Use the navigation buttons to cycle through all 12 cards.

CLICK TO FLIP

Phase III Fee Percentage

Click the card to flip · Use Prev / Next to navigate

← PREV



NEXT →

SECTION M · ASSESSMENT · PRINTABLE CUT CARDS

STUDY TOOLS · PRINT-READY

Printable Cut Cards

Print this page, cut along the dashed borders, and use as physical study cards.

Phase III Fee %

35% of total fee. Construction Documents. Highest documentation risk; errors drive contractor disputes and change orders.

Laundry Formula

Keys $\times$ 15 lbs $\div$ 7 hrs = lbs/hr. Luxury = 20 lbs/key. Correctional = 3 lbs/inmate. Size equipment to this capacity.

K-12 Rate

\$300/SF estimated equipment cost. Fee range: 4-6%. USDA National School Lunch Program compliance required.

Hospitality Rate

\$325/SF kitchen. Fee range: 3.5-5%. Vendor-neutral language: "F&B independence."

Hospital SF Formula

40 SF/bed (with retail). Hospice: 25 SF/bed. Rehab/Mental Health: 20 SF/bed (no retail component).

Variance Letter Signer

Signed by: Cathey Create The Edge, CEO. The Litigation Letter is signed by: [Company Owner] C. Create The Edge, President. Different letters, different signatories.

Travel Billing Rule

\$1,600/day site visit + \$0.665/mile beyond 50 miles from [City, State]. Always a separate line item; never bundled.

Revit / BIM Rate

\$160/hr. Production drawings, BIM coordination, clash detection. File format: .rvt for coordination; PDF and DWG for contractors.

Principal Rate

\$275/hr and \$1,500/day. Highest billable position. Additional meetings (all levels) billed at \$225/hr.

Correctional Language

Use "residents" or "persons" in all client-facing text. Never "inmates." Applies to proposals, emails, and presentations without exception.

Insurance Record

Zero claims on any coverage in 57+ years of operation. Cited explicitly in the Variance Letter. One of the firm's strongest credibility signals.

Pre-Flight Group 3

Risk Flags and Final Steps: scope ambiguities, missing authorizations, unaddressed client requirements, [CRM Software] filing, Box naming convention.

MODULE M · PRESENTATION

PRESENTATION SLIDES

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